

EXPERIMENT 5

Dashboard Creation in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To design and implement a Dashboard in Zoho Creator for visualizing and managing library data using various widgets, charts, and reports, and to understand the process of building an interactive dashboard for a library management application.

2. Introduction

A Dashboard in Zoho Creator is a visual interface that provides a consolidated view of key metrics and data points from an application. It allows users to monitor important information at a glance using widgets, charts, graphs, and quick links. Dashboards help in decision-making by presenting real-time data in an organized and visually appealing manner. Zoho Creator provides drag-and-drop dashboard components that can be configured to display data from various forms and reports.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To understand the concept and purpose of dashboards in Zoho Creator.
- To learn how to create and configure a dashboard using different widgets.
- To understand how to add charts, summary cards, and quick links to a dashboard.
- To explore the customization of dashboard layout and components.
- To develop a functional dashboard for a real-world library management use case.

4. Procedure

- Log in to the Zoho Creator platform.
- Open the existing application or create a new application for the required use case.
- Navigate to the Dashboard section and create a new dashboard.
- Add summary widgets to display key metrics such as total books, books issued, overdue books, and active members.
- Configure the widgets with appropriate data sources and aggregation functions.
- Add chart widgets to visualize book availability and category distribution.
- Add quick links to forms for easy book entry, issue, return, and member navigation.
- Arrange and customize the dashboard layout for better visual presentation.
- Save and preview the dashboard to verify its appearance and functionality.
- Publish the application after completing the dashboard creation.

5. Illustrative Example

Consider a Library Management System in which books, members, issue records, return information and overdue details are managed through a Zoho Creator application.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

Create a Dashboard for the Library Management System. Add summary widgets such as Total Books, Books Issued, Overdue Books, and Active Members. Add a Book Availability section displaying counts for Available, Issued, Reserved, and Overdue books. Add Quick Links for adding a new book, issuing a book, returning a book, and viewing the member list. Add a chart such as Books by Category to visualize the distribution of books across categories. Store and display all data in real time. Generate reports to view and manage book, member and issue information.

5.2 Illustrative Dashboard Design

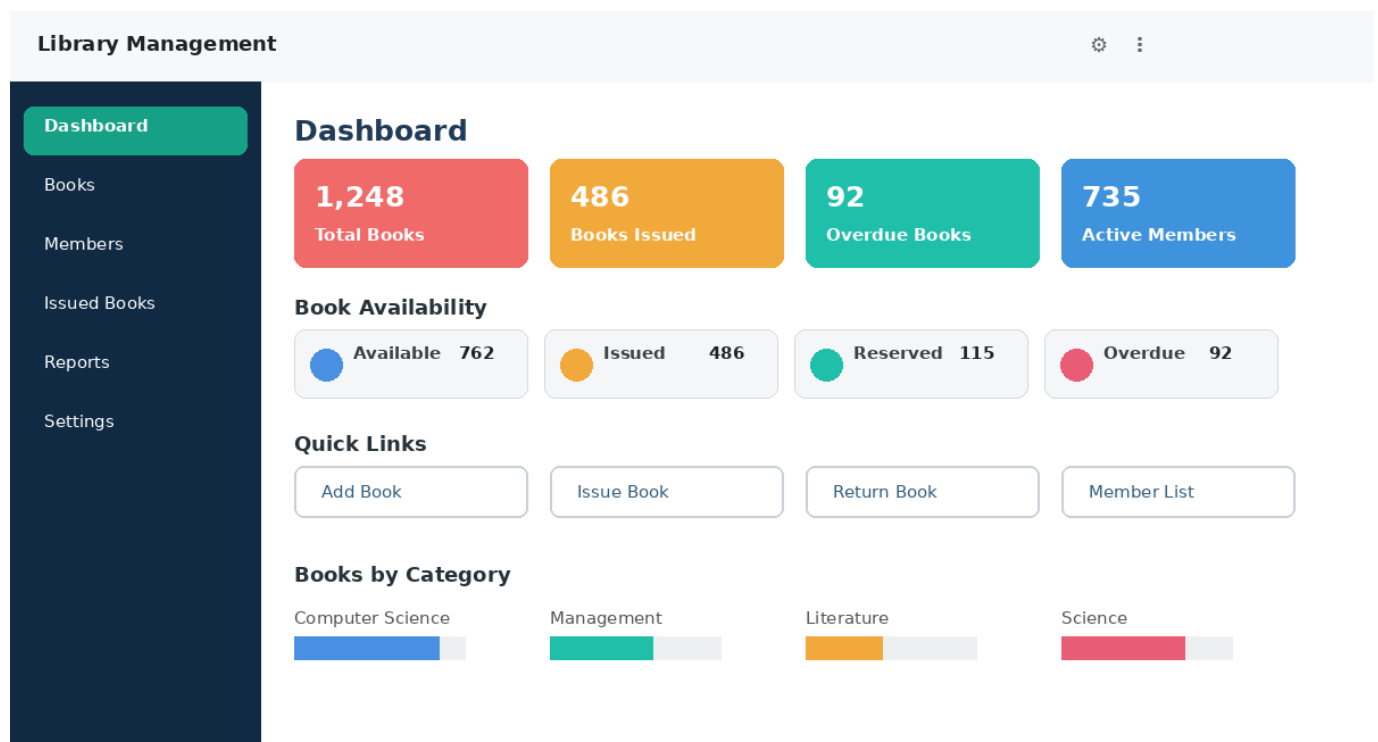


Figure 1: Library Management Dashboard in Zoho Creator.

6. Dashboard Components

- Summary Widgets – Display Total Books, Books Issued, Overdue Books and Active Members.
- Book Availability – Shows the current distribution of available, issued, reserved and overdue books.
- Quick Links – Provide direct access to Add Book, Issue Book, Return Book and Member List.
- Category Chart – Visualizes the distribution of books across major categories.
- Reports – Provide detailed views of book, member and issue records.

7. Advantages and Limitations

7.1 Advantages

- Provides a consolidated view of important library metrics.
- Visual representation of data improves understanding and monitoring.
- Real-time data updates help monitor book availability and issue status.
- Quick links enable easy navigation and data entry.
- Dashboards can be customized with drag-and-drop components.
- Reduces the need for manual report generation.

7.2 Limitations

- Complex dashboard customization may require Deluge scripting.
- Performance may be affected with large datasets.
- Advanced chart types may require additional configuration.
- Dashboards depend on the capabilities of the selected platform.
- Large or highly specialized systems may need additional development.

8. Result

The experiment was completed successfully by studying dashboard creation and implementing an interactive dashboard for the Library Management System in Zoho Creator. The exercise demonstrated how summary widgets, charts, quick links, and navigation components can be combined to create a comprehensive dashboard with reduced coding effort.